

# The command `\DocumentMetadata` and conformance with PDF/A and PDF/UE

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## 1 Introduction

This document is about using `\DocumentMetadata`. This is the canonical way to force modern  $\text{\LaTeX}$  compilers to include metadata. Metadata in turn is the base for creating certain more strict flavors of PDF, namely PDF/A, PDF/X and PDF/UA. Whereas at time of this writing, PDF/X is not very much supported, this is different for the other standards.

In general, one can specify the standard in `\DocumentMetadata`, and the compiler tries to reach conformance, but there is no guarantee, even in absence of warnings. Thus, verification is mandatory and the canonical trustable and free verification tool with long term support is `verapdf` sponsored by the EU. Since this document also describes the circumstances under which conformance can be reached, we added a short description of `verapdf` in Section 2.

## 2 On `verapdf`

The list of return values given in Table 1. As can be seen, one code, 0, indicates that all checks were performed and all validation succeeded, one result means, the test could be performed and failed, and the other return values more or less indicate, that the proper tests could not be performed. Parsing errors means, it is no valid PDF file at all, so the proper tests could not be performed. Note that this application invoked `verapdf` with exactly one PDF file.

| Enum                      | Exit code | Explanation                                             |
|---------------------------|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| VALID                     | 0         | all files parsed and valid.                             |
| INVALID                   | 1         | Invalid PDF/A file(s) found.                            |
| BAD_PARAMS                | 2         | Invalid command line parameters.                        |
| OOM                       | 3         | Out of Java heap space (memory).                        |
| NO_FILES                  | 4         | No files to process, also if no given files exist.      |
| IO_EXCEPTION              | 6         | I/O Exception while processing.                         |
| –                         | 5         | Does not occur.                                         |
| FAILED_PARSING            | 7         | Failed to parse one or more files.                      |
| ENCRYPTED_FILES           | 8         | Some PDFs encrypted.                                    |
| VERAPDF_EXCEPTION         | 9         | VeraPDF exception while processing.                     |
| JAXB_EXCEPTION            | 10        | Java XML marshalling exception while processing result. |
| FAILED_MULTIPROCESS_START | 11        | Failed to start multiprocess.                           |
| INTERRUPTED_EXCEPTION     | 12        | Interrupted exception while processing.                 |

Table 1: The exit codes of **verapdf**